

HTTP ARCHIVE • JAN 2020–MAR 2026

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive trends in page weight, protocols, and security

For web performance engineers and front-end architects evaluating infrastructure trends

CRAWL SAMPLE

16M desktop / 12.5M mobile URLs

COVERAGE

page weight • requests • protocols • CSS

SOURCE

HTTP Archive State of the Web report

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



CURRENT DESKTOP CRAWL

16M

stabilized by mid-2023 onward

CURRENT MOBILE CRAWL

12.5M

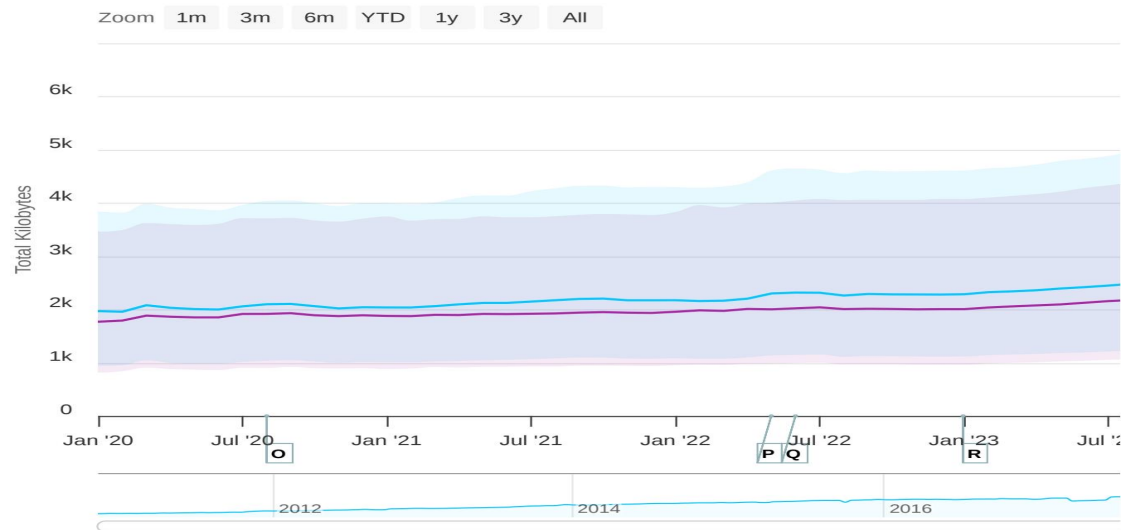
mobile plateau follows desktop

Interpretation

The mid-2022 step-change materially improves longitudinal coverage before the current high-volume plateau.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total Kilobytes time-series with IQR bands



DESKTOP MEDIAN

~2,000 KB

MOBILE MEDIAN

~1,900 KB

DESKTOP P75

>4,000 KB

Both desktop and mobile medians are up ~25%, reflecting steadily richer payloads over the observation period.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Median resource requests remain high and edge upward, but connection counts decline as HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing consolidates traffic.

DESKTOP REQUESTS

76

▲ 2.7% over period

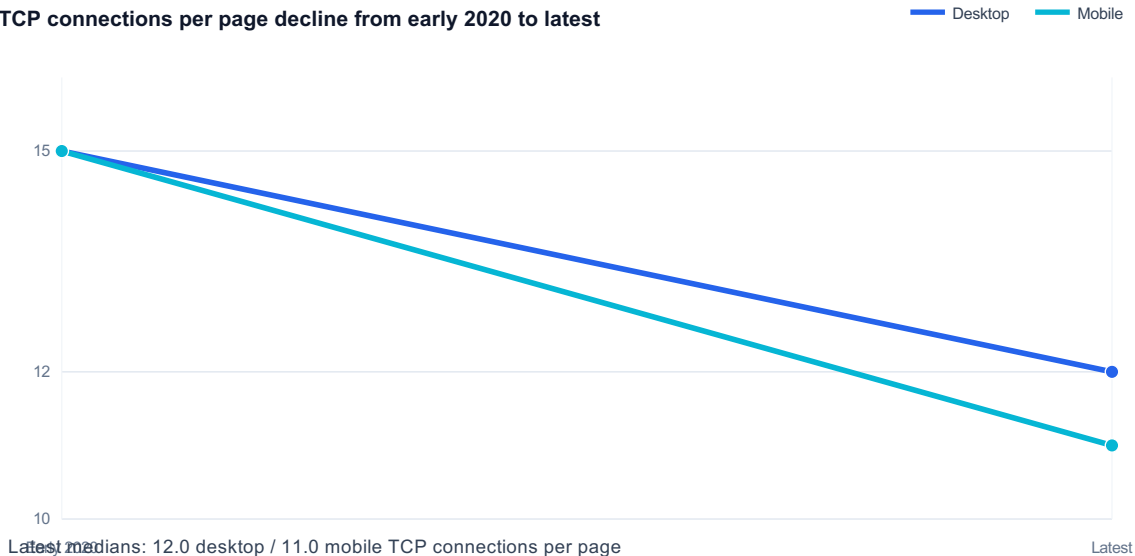
MOBILE REQUESTS

71

▲ 2.9% over period

Requests/page

TCP connections per page decline from early 2020 to latest



HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

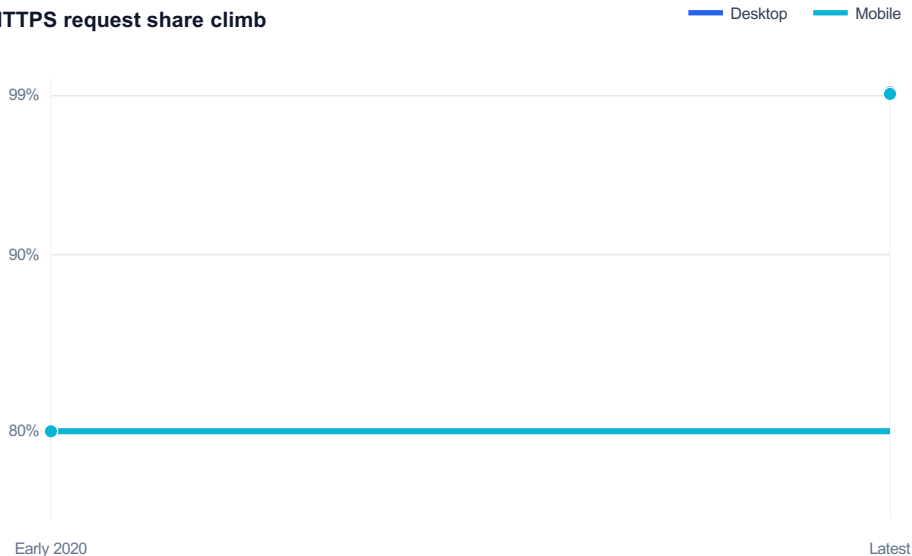
HTTPS REQUESTS

99%+

99.2% desktop
99.1% mobile

Up roughly 19–20 percentage points from around
80% in early 2020.

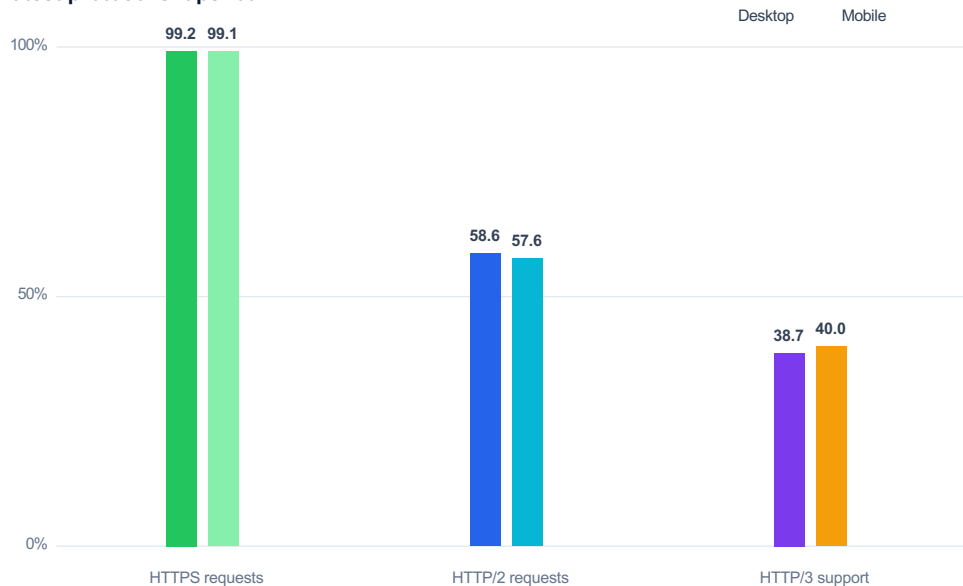
HTTPS request share climb



Plaintext HTTP is effectively gone from the modern crawl baseline.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

Latest protocol snapshot



HTTP/3 trajectory



Measurement caveat

HTTP Archive reports HTTP/3 support rather than actual usage because fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 before discovering HTTP/3 via Alt-Svc headers.

HTTP/2 growth remains modest at ~58–59%, partly as HTTP/3 absorbs newer adoption.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

Current font-display adoption and growth direction



DESKTOP PAGES

40.1%

up 14.9% since 2020

MOBILE PAGES

42.5%

up 61.0% since 2020

Why it matters

font-display helps avoid FOIT during web font loading, but more than half of pages still risk invisible text.

Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

01

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020.

02

HTTPS is the new baseline

99%+ of requests use HTTPS; unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct.

03

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing metric

Support rose from near-zero to ~40%, while HTTP/2 holds around ~58–59%.

04

Connections fall despite requests rising

Multiplexing has cut median TCP connections per page by 15–27%.

05

font-display still underused

~40–42% adoption leaves significant room to reduce FOIT risk.

Benchmark your own sites against these baselines: payload KB, request count, protocol support, HTTPS share, TCP connections, and font-display adoption.